

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Sowjanya Kalepalli

Address: 26 Oxford Road Carshalton SM5 3QY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to formally object to the proposed conversion of the former ambulance station into a centre.

While I fully recognise the importance of community facilities and respect the role they play in society, I believe that the specific nature and location of this site make the proposed change of use inappropriate. My concerns are outlined below:

Impact on Residential Amenity (Noise and Disturbance):

The site is located within a quiet residential area. Its previous use as an emergency service base involved intermittent and generally predictable activity. In contrast, a religious centre is likely to generate concentrated periods of high activity, particularly during evenings and weekends when residents reasonably expect peace and quiet.

Noise arising from large gatherings, arrivals and departures, vehicle movements, and any amplified sound could result in significant disturbance to neighbouring properties.

Highway Safety and Parking Pressure:

The surrounding residential streets are narrow and already experience high parking demand. A centre typically attracts a substantial number of visitors at the same time, and the site does not appear to provide sufficient off-street parking to accommodate a full congregation.

This is likely to lead to overspill parking on residential roads, potentially blocking driveways, restricting access for emergency vehicles, and creating hazards for pedestrians.

Change in the Character of the Area:

The neighbourhood is a quiet, established residential area. The proposed intensification of use - transforming a low-occupancy service building into a high-capacity public assembly venue - represents a significant material change of use.

In my view, this would be inconsistent with the tranquil character of the area as defined in the Sutton Local Plan.

Inadequate Access Arrangements:

The existing access points were designed primarily for ambulance vehicles and may not be suitable for accommodating a high volume of pedestrian traffic, including families and children. This raises concerns regarding road safety and general site accessibility.

Given these concerns, I respectfully request that the Planning Committee require a full Noise Impact Assessment and a comprehensive Transport Statement before any determination is made.

For the reasons outlined above, I urge the Council to refuse this application in order to protect the residential amenity and safety of local residents.